Cody Adams

Platform Engineering, DevOps & SRE Leader

Novi, MI (Open to Remote) | 248-420-0032 | coadams@umich.edu | popebob.github.io | linkedin.com/in/cody-adams-659a121a

Summary

Platform engineering, DevOps, and site reliability engineering (SRE) leader with 20+ years building and operating infrastructure across startups, growth-stage SaaS, and Fortune 100 enterprises — equally effective as a hands-on, full-stack technical owner and as an engineering executive. Currently own the entire infrastructure, security, and IT function for a HIPAA-regulated healthcare data platform — cloud, DevOps, SRE, security engineering and operations, corporate IT, and the HIPAA and SOC 2 compliance programs — on a $5–7M budget, roughly 60% of company operating spend. Career-long owner of incident and change management, BC/DR, data protection, compliance-as-code, and FinOps/cloud unit-economics practices, defining public-facing SLAs, the SLOs beneath them, and the error budgets that govern change velocity, while driving down mean time to resolution (MTTR) in 99.9%+ SLA environments throughout. Deep cloud expertise regardless of hosting model — bare-metal and private data centers, Azure, and AWS alike — plus container orchestration and Infrastructure as Code (IaC), with end-to-end multi-tenant design — application, data, and infrastructure — at every company since 2012, a track record of leading SOC 2, ISO 27001, FedRAMP, and NIST 800-53 compliance programs, and zero-downtime infrastructure transformations executed at enterprise scale. Consistently recognized by peers and direct reports for pairing that technical range with genuine, individually-invested leadership.

Career Highlights

- Own the entire infrastructure, security, and IT function at Opala on a **$5–7M budget — roughly 60% of company operating spend** — with a 10-person organization; inherited a $1.8M budget deficit in March 2025 and closed it to positive within the first year.
- **Multi-tenancy end to end for fourteen years:** led and implemented tenant designs top to bottom — application, data, and infrastructure — at Plex, Ford, Delta Dental, Hoylu, and Opala, including the customer-specific and regulatory compliance requirements that shape isolation on regulated platforms.
- Grew Ford’s 2-person “skunkworks” lab into a 150-person organization — including Ford’s first offshore production operations — establishing the enterprise’s Next Generation Data Center function and cutting internal VM delivery from 55 days to 5 minutes.
- Promoted or expanded in scope in every role held, from Data Center Administrator at Plex to Director of Platform Engineering today; manages a 10-person organization at Opala, including the cross-org dotted-line reporting structures he designed and implemented.
- Full lifecycle, full-stack technical ownership at every role — architecture through hands-on incident response, including debugging across unfamiliar languages and systems. The IaC libraries, DevOps frameworks, and change and incident processes left at each company stayed in use after moving on.
- Owns RFP responses and statements of work today, as at Hoylu — where the statement of work written and sold there closed a U.S. Navy contract, delivered end to end.
- Leads large-scale demos and training; owns skills-matrix design, target behavior frameworks, and tooling/integration architecture in every organization led.
- Systems depth few platform leaders bring to the table: expert-level Windows and Linux administration, OS clustering spanning physical data centers, and filesystems engineering.
- Early AI adopter: led Hoylu’s initial AI rollout (2024); at Opala — a Coalition for Health AI (CHAI) participant — drives SOC 2/HIPAA-ready AI practices and helped implement a Databricks Genie AI workflow integration and a healthcare AI chatbot application.

Core Skills

- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** Bare-Metal & Private Data Center, VMware/Traditional VM Hosting, Hybrid & Multi-Cloud (Azure, AWS incl. GovCloud), Container Orchestration (HashiCorp Nomad, Kubernetes/AKS), Landing Zone Architecture (DC & Cloud), Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, incl. COTS/Vendor Platforms), High-Availability & Low-Latency Design, Secure-by-Default Architecture (Edge to Enterprise Fleet Scale)
- **Distributed Systems & Multi-Tenancy:** End-to-End Multi-Tenant Design (Application, Data & Infrastructure Layers), Tenant Isolation, Data Partitioning & Scalability Patterns, Microservices & Service Decomposition, Inter-Service Contracts & API Platform Strategy, Event-Driven Architecture (RabbitMQ, Azure Service Bus, Publish/Subscribe — since 2012)

- **Languages & Scripting:** C, C++, C#, .NET/.NET Core, Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, Go, Python, Bash, PowerShell, custom DSLs, YAML/JSON
- **Systems, Data Center & Storage Engineering:** Windows & Linux (Expert-Level Administration), Filesystems Engineering, Purpose-Built Data Center Design (Rack/Power/Cooling Up), Spine-and-Leaf Network Fabric, SAN & NAS Storage Architecture, Synchronous Dual-Site Write Acknowledgment, Geo-Spanning Microsoft & Linux OS Clustering, Special-Purpose Compute Architecture (Mainframe/Batch, HPC, Big Data), Capacity & Hardware Refresh Modeling
- **Network & Security Engineering:** DNS & Core Infrastructure Services, WAN/LAN Planning & Operations (incl. PBX/Telephony), Cross-Cloud & Multi-Cloud Networking (Peering, Transit Gateways, Interconnects), BGP, VPN, CDN Architecture, Production Firewall Management, Zscaler (Zero-Trust Access), PKI & Encryption, Blue & Red Team Security Operations, Network & Application Security Engineering
- **Identity & Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Workforce & B2C/External ID), OIDC, SAML, SCIM, SSO/Federation, Zero-Trust IAM
- **Security & Compliance:** HIPAA, SOC 2, ISO 27001, SOX 404, FedRAMP, NIST 800-53, CSA CAIQ, GDPR, CMS Interoperability, Compliance Automation (Drata), DevSecOps
- **Governance & Resilience:** Change & Incident Management, BC/DR, Compliance-as-Code, GRC Engineering, Immutable & Secure Infrastructure, Shift-Left DevOps, Customer-Facing Technical & Compliance Audits (Pre- & Post-Sales)
- **CI/CD & Automation:** Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, TeamCity, Bamboo, Octopus Deploy, TFS, Docker, Packer, Ansible, Chef, ARM/Azure CLI, GitOps, ChatOps, Automated/Self-Healing Infrastructure
- **Release Engineering & Version Control:** Centralized-to-Distributed VCS Migration (TFVC/SVN → Git), Branching/Merging/Release/Deployment Strategy Design, End-to-End Productionization
- **Developer Experience (DX):** Self-Service Platforms, Developer Tooling & Enablement, Shift-Left Operations — since 2012
- **Observability & SRE:** ELK Stack, Wazuh SIEM, Grafana, Prometheus, AppDynamics, CloudWatch, CloudTrail, Azure Application Insights, Public-Facing SLA & SLO Definition, Error Budget Management, MTTR Reduction, Incident Response, SRE Practices & On-Call Frameworks
- **AI Enablement:** AI Adoption & Governance (SOC 2/HIPAA-Ready), Databricks Genie AI Workflow Integration, Healthcare AI Applications, CHAI Participation
- **Leadership & Delivery:** Multi-Million $ Budget Ownership, Managing Managers & Team Leads, FinOps & Cloud Unit Economics (COGS Metrics), Org Design & Hiring, RFP/RFX Response & Statement of Work Authoring, Managed-Service Provider Strategy & Sourcing (IT Operations, SOC/MDR, Internal Audit), Agile/Scrum Coaching (PSM I), ITIL/ITSM, Vendor & Program Management, Board/Executive Reporting, End-to-End Support Model Design (L0 Automation → L1 Helpdesk → Incident/Problem Management → Roadmap), Program Planning (6-Week to 6-Year Horizons)
- **Application & Data Layer:** Reverse Proxies & Web Servers, Database Infrastructure Operations (Provisioning, Backup/Failover, Patching — SQL & NoSQL), Databricks (Data Architecture, Tenancy & Governance, Security & Compliance, AI Data Architecture), Caching Systems

Professional Experience

Director of Platform Engineering

Opala — Seattle, WA (Remote) | March 2025 – Present

- Own the entire infrastructure, security, and IT function — cloud infrastructure, DevOps, SRE, security engineering and operations, corporate IT, and the HIPAA and SOC 2 compliance programs — on a $5–7M budget representing roughly 60% of company operating spend; expanded the role from Cloud DevOps and IT Operations, redesigned the org chart around it — including designing and implementing the cross-org dotted-line reporting structures — and directly manage a 10-person organization.
- Established SRE practices, observability standards, and incident response frameworks for a HIPAA-regulated, CMS interoperability-mandated healthcare platform; define the public-facing SLA and the SLOs beneath it, and lead change decisions weighed against remaining error budget.
- Led and implemented the platform’s multi-tenancy model across the application, data, and infrastructure layers, including the customer-specific and regulatory compliance requirements that shape tenant isolation in healthcare.
- Own Databricks data architecture — tenancy design and governance in production, security and compliance posture within the platform, and the AI data architecture beneath its AI workloads.

- Drive multi-cloud (Azure/AWS) architecture decisions with security and compliance as first-class design constraints; deploy to production daily via IaC and GitHub Actions, and built GitHub OIDC federation with centralized DevSecOps policy enforcement across all environments.
- Delivered 30+ reusable Infrastructure-as-Code modules in Azure CLI, extensive Python-based access audits, DevSecOps pipelines, and the platform's initial Docker build pipelines.
- Own cybersecurity posture, audit readiness, and compliance evidence automation (Drata, with Azure and AWS integrations) — positioning compliance as a business enabler rather than a checkbox exercise.
- Own RFP responses and statements of work; designed the long-term IT operations and SOC/MDR managed-service strategy, deployed the IT Operations MSP, and added internal audit MSPs.
- Hands-on owner of enterprise DNS, firewalls, VPNs, Zscaler zero-trust access, identity lifecycle, endpoint security, developer tooling, and day-to-day IT operations including direct client support.
- Drive Opala's AI adoption — SOC 2/HIPAA-ready practices, Coalition for Health AI (CHAI) participation, and key implementation of a Databricks Genie AI workflow integration and a healthcare AI chatbot application.

Director of DevOps *(promoted from Senior DevOps Engineer)*

Hoylu — Kirkland, WA | August 2020 – February 2025

- Hoylu's first dedicated DevOps/Platform Engineering hire; owned the full platform engineering function for a global SaaS collaboration platform serving enterprise and government customers, managing a team of 8 (DevOps and backend engineers) and expanding scope through multiple company-wide workforce reductions.
- Reported directly to the VP of Engineering and CEO; designed customer usage-based COGS metrics that gave the board real-time visibility into cloud unit economics, and led cost optimization that materially reduced operational spend while maintaining reliability and growth capacity.
- Led ISO/IEC 27001 certification end-to-end (certified to :2013 in 2021, transitioned to :2022 in 2024) and architected a fully customized SaaS deployment in AWS GovCloud — leading FedRAMP Moderate compliance activities — unlocking enterprise and government customer acquisition.
- Wrote and sold the statement of work that closed a U.S. Navy contract, then led that engagement end to end — a run-it-yourself, air-gapped GovCloud solution built to IL4 requirements; owned RFP responses and security audits, building an RFP/audit FAQ handed to Customer Success for faster, consistent answers.
- Designed a zero-trust, cloud-native platform on the HashiCorp stack (Consul, Nomad, Terraform, Vault) with an automated mutual-TLS service mesh, RabbitMQ messaging, and Wazuh SIEM; self-healing, automated infrastructure supported a public SLA without headcount growth.
- Worked hands-on in the application codebase (Kotlin, TypeScript, C#) alongside the backend team — partnering on design review and architecture, and identifying and implementing the changes required to ship air-gapped.
- Built 25+ reusable Terraform modules, embedded DAST/SAST and penetration testing into the SDLC, and led Hoylu's initial AI rollout (2024).

DevOps Practice Manager / Cloud Architect

Coretek Services — Farmington, MI | May 2019 – August 2020

- Built Coretek's DevOps consulting practice from zero, delivering cross-industry enterprise and mid-market engagements from initial economic assessment (dozens delivered) through production delivery.
- Led cloud migrations and Azure foundation deployments aligned to the Azure Well-Architected Framework, plus Azure Serverless, Azure Service Bus event-driven integration, and Azure DevOps migration engagements.
- Defined and launched the DevOps service catalog (containerization, CI/CD, IaC) using Azure DevOps, AKS, Azure CLI, and Terraform — turning bespoke client engagements into repeatable offerings; built and trained cross-functional delivery teams spanning staff, clients, and vendors.

DevOps Platform Manager

Delta Dental of Michigan — Okemos, MI | November 2018 – May 2019

- Led development of a Kubernetes-based, metal-up enterprise application hosting platform in a spine-and-leaf private data center — high availability with no cloud abstraction layer — with direct CTO-level engagement.
- Architected platform-level BC/DR so application teams inherited business continuity and disaster recovery posture by default; maintained federal compliance requirements and tenant isolation across the platform.
- Modernized ITSM processes (Change, Incident, Problem Management) and integrated observability tooling (ELK, AppDynamics), reducing central IT dependency through developer self-service.

DevOps Principal Architect – Data Center of the Future

Ford Motor Company — Dearborn, MI | March 2017 – November 2018

- Lead architect and agile coach across a concurrent Platform-as-a-Service portfolio delivered as infrastructure-as-microservices, influencing hundreds of engineers with developer experience as a first-class design concern; managed and coached managers as the organization scaled.
- Replaced foundational infrastructure of a live global operation in real time with zero downtime, embedding compliance and security controls that had not previously existed.
- Delivered platforms including Kubernetes (Containers as a Service), Pivotal Cloud Foundry, SQL Server PaaS, VMware vRealize Operations, IBM API Connect, and F5 iWorkflow network orchestration, with event-driven orchestration inside Ford’s proprietary internal cloud orchestrator.
- Established new release engineering practices for IT Operations and trained the Release Manager role into existence; productized internal service delivery, cutting VM provisioning from 55 days to 5 minutes.
- Displaced incumbent teams and legacy platforms when the solutions delivered outperformed them, most notably replacing Ford’s enterprise Active Directory environment.

Cloud and DevOps Consultant

Ford Motor Company — Dearborn, MI | September 2015 – March 2017

- Defined Ford’s Data Center of the Future architecture vision across compute, storage, network, cloud, big data, and hosting, with compliance as a first-class design requirement where none had previously existed.
- Designed Ford’s first two purpose-built enterprise data centers — from the rack, power, and cooling level up, on a spine-and-leaf fabric — and presented the strategy directly to the CIO.
- Served as compute architect across three distinct domains — mainframe/batch, HPC, and Big Data — evaluating a single x86 platform against the justifications for special-purpose compute, and defining the IaaS, capacity, and hardware refresh model.
- Engineered Microsoft and Linux clustering spanning physical data centers to meet defined latency requirements, designed so writes committed into both data center SANs before acknowledgment.
- Established and operated the Next Generation Lab, a production-grade VMware SDDC private cloud proving ground for new platform capabilities, with full asset, service delivery, and vendor management ownership.
- Collaborated directly with Chef’s and HashiCorp’s engineering teams on core Infrastructure-as-Code tooling and DevOps workflow design for Ford’s automation strategy.

DevOps Team Lead *(promoted from Data Center Administrator)*

Plex Systems, Inc. — Auburn Hills, MI | March 2012 – September 2015

- Full-lifecycle infrastructure ownership in a 24/7, SOX 404-compliant, 99.9% public-SLA SaaS environment — managing change against the ~43-minute monthly error budget it allows.
- Originated the platform’s service decomposition and multi-tenancy work — tenant isolation and data partitioning across application, data, and infrastructure layers — with publish/subscribe messaging patterns in production from 2012.
- Built the company’s initial CI/CD, IaC, and ChatOps toolchain, driving deployment frequency from periodic to continuous, including blue/green and mid-day production deployments.
- Reduced VM build time by 90% through automation, cutting SOX 404 audit burden in the process — earning the 2014 Q3 “Plex Impact” Innovation Award.
- Owned spine-and-leaf data center networking and SAN/NAS storage architecture for the production SaaS estate.
- Primary on-call 24/7/365 for production: rapid response, incident commander, and problem report owner using the 8D methodology.

Earlier Career

Brose North America — Systems Administrator | Auburn Hills, MI | July 2008 – April 2012

- Grew a regional IT role into North American leadership scope, establishing data-driven ITIL practices and delivering a 20% local IT headcount reduction through automation.

Prior: ~3 years of self-employed IT work and PC technician roles (2005–2008).

Certifications & Education

Certifications: Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I), 2017 | Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900), 2019 | Scrum Fundamentals Certified.

Education: B.S., Computer Science — Systems/Network Design, University of Michigan–Flint (2003–2010).